
Skill development and tactics:

Visualisation, use of ritual, training for decision making, visual awareness training, group cohesion

Long-term technical preparation**Mechanical:**

Refinement of technique (leading to perfect model, use of technology and feedback, video and computer software, 'prozone')

Students need to understand about different ergogenic aids, including force plates, pedometry, heart rate monitoring, use of GPS technology, lactate/anaerobic threshold measurement

3.3 Managing elite performance**Centres of excellence****History and development of elite support:**

- overview of different systems (East German, Australian, US, UK)

Support roles and finance

Students need to understand the needs of elite athletes, including:

- financial support (lottery, state and other sources of funding)
- training needs (the use and benefits of academies and training camps for major events, such as the Olympic Games)

Technical support**The role of technology**

- training analysis, enhancement and evaluation for sporting performance
- the concept of sports science and support (the drawing together of everything done in preparation for optimum sports performance)
- the role of national agencies, both sporting and political, in athlete preparation

Unit description

The tasks undertaken in *Unit 2: The Critical Sports Performer* lay the foundation for students to specialise in **one** practical performance role and progress this performance, and undertake **three** further tasks.

The list of approved physical activities can be found in the GCE Physical Education Internal Assessment Guide which can be found on our website.

Students will construct a development plan to further progress their performance as player/participants, leaders or officials.

They will also research **one** of these roles in an international context, taking in grass roots participation, elite performance and other factors. Students will then continue to refine their performances in **one** chosen role.

Lastly, they will plan their life in physical activity, from the Advanced Subsidiary course to the potential opportunities and performance structure open to them, thereby outlining a 'time line', through school, college, university, club, veterans and future roles.

Assessment information

Students must undertake **four** tasks for assessment in this unit. They will be required to submit their completed tasks for internal centre marking using the Pearson criteria, and for external moderation.

- *Task 4.1 (Development Plan)* requires students to plan, research, perform, record, review and evaluate a development plan for **one** of the roles taken for *Task 2.1 (Personal Performance)*. The development plan will be unique to the individual and will show students how to realise and progress their performance. This task is further divided into **three** components:
 - ◆ component one — planning and researching
 - ◆ component two — performing and recording
 - ◆ component three — review and evaluation.

Components one and two are marked out of 20, and component three is marked out of 5, to give an overall mark out of 45. This mark should be compared against the holistic criteria to ensure an accurate grade is awarded.

- *Task 4.2 (International Study)* engages students through independent research and establishes, by expanding on *Task 2.2 (Local Study)* and *Task 2.3 (National Study)*, a knowledge and understanding of the opportunities and provisions for mass participation and elite development in another nation. This task is marked out of 15.
- *Task 4.3 (Progressive Participation)* provides further routes for a student to undertake continued participation in **one** chosen role and through progressive practises and organised performances to refine this performance. This task is marked out of 20.
- *Task 4.4 (Life Plan)* requires students to write a 'life plan', the development of which requires independent research into their opportunities for participation. Students should consider different 'age stages' and how they will seek both continued and alternative sporting participation in a variety of roles. This task is marked out of 10.

The total number of marks for each task is listed above. **One** overall mark out of **90** is required.

Students must be assessed in line with the published instructions for assessment and the assessment criteria for the task.

Additional guidance about task requirements can be found in the GCE Physical Education Internal Assessment Guide which can be found on our website.

AS/A2 Progression and performance assessments

Students undertaking Unit 4 will now specialise in a single performance role. This will by the nature of an advanced coursework unit allow them to evolve as more knowledgeable and able participants and contributors to a single physical activity. It is envisaged that students will therefore begin the GCE Advanced course in September one band below that awarded for the Advanced Subsidiary course.

For example, an AS student awarded 14 out of 15 at Advanced Subsidiary level would have been placed in the band 13–15. At the commencement of the A2 course they would be placed, albeit provisionally, in the mark band 13–16.

Centres need to take into account when making their initial assessment of students any specific attainments achieved during the end of the Advanced Subsidiary course and the commencement of the GCE Advanced course. These may include, for example, gaining a governing body qualification or the completion of a summer-based sport such as athletics.

Over the life span of Unit 4 students will seek opportunities to further develop their chosen role and thereby potentially gain a higher-band award, thus showing said progression from the final AS to the final A2 mark in four key areas:

- increased physiological status — maturation
- increased psychological expertise
- increased technical and tactical proficiency
- increased knowledge and understanding of the sphere of performing in their activity.